

RunAs Service, etc. If you don't have any NTFS partitions, Distributed Link Tracking will not help in any way. Similarly, if you don't have any printers installed, you can turn off Print Spooler.

Personalised menus

Windows 2000 introduced personalised menus, tracking usage of menu items across all local users. Items that have not been used recently are hidden away, providing faster access to frequently used shortcuts. This is a very resourceful addition to the user interface, but comes at a price. Every time you open a menu, Windows checks up which items are to be displayed and which ones are to

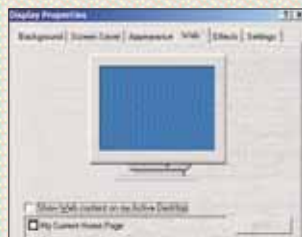


Disable personalised menus in Windows 2000

be hidden. This is quite unnecessary and one can actually feel the delay on slow systems. Turn off personalised menus from **Start > Settings > Taskbar & Start Menu**.

Active Desktop

Though there haven't been any known issues with Active Desktop on Windows 2000 as against 98, it can slow down



Web content on the desktop hogs resources

the OS. You should avoid using GIFs and JPEG images as your wallpaper. To disable Web content on the desktop, right-click on the desktop, click Properties and switch to the Web tab. Uncheck the box to 'Show Web content on my Active Desktop' and click OK.

Away with display effects

Windows 2000 brought with it a new set of display effects for menus, lists and windows. Turning these off will save up some resources. The performance gain will be more apparent on low-end computers, but you will definitely notice it when minimising or maximising windows. Right-click on the desktop, click Properties and switch to the Effects tab.

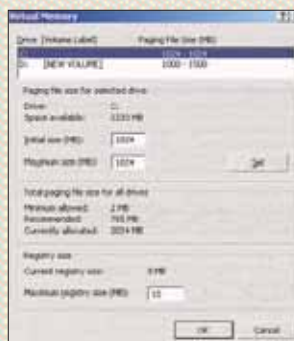


Squeeze out even the last drop of power by turning off display effects

Disable 'Use transition effects for menus and tooltips', 'Smooth edges of screen fonts' and 'Show window contents while dragging'.

Performance options

Built over the NT architecture, Windows 2000 provides performance options similar to Windows NT 4. Open **Control Panel > System > Advanced** and click Performance Options. Here, you can set Windows to optimise processor and memory usage for



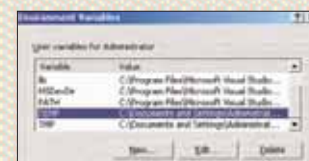
Setting the swap file sizes and the maximum registry size

applications or background services. For desktop PCs, you don't need to change this setting. If it were a server, you would choose to optimise for background services. You can also change the virtual memory settings. You can have one swap file per drive, each with different sizes (Check the tip Optimise virtual memory in the Windows 98 section for more on swap files). You will notice that here you can also set the maximum registry size. You should not set this to a very low value, or you will start facing problems as you

install more programs. Setting a small size does make a difference though—Windows loads the registry into memory, so the smaller the registry, lesser is the memory used.

Maintaining temporary files

By default, Windows 2000 sets up different Temp folders for each user along with the \Winnt\Temp folder. Thus, when clearing out temporary files, you have to check this folder, as well as the Temp folder under each user's account profile, under \Documents and Settings\<User>\Local Settings\Temp. This is as unmanageable as it is irritating. Fortunately, you can change this behaviour. Open **Control Panel > System > Advanced** and click Environment Variables. You will see two boxes for User variables and System variables. Delete the TEMP and TMP variables for the user, or set their paths



Change environment variables

to %SystemRoot%\TEMP. You will have to repeat this for every local user.

Power boot

On the System Properties dialog, under the Advanced tab, click Startup and Recovery to change the boot options for the NT Flex boot loader. If you have only Windows 2000 installed, disable 'Display a